

Parth Chawla

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EDUCATION

University of California, Davis <i>Ph.D. in Agricultural & Resource (Applied) Economics</i>	Davis, CA, USA 2021 – 2026
Trinity College Dublin <i>M.Sc. in Economics</i>	Dublin, Ireland 2018 – 2019
Royal Holloway, University of London <i>B.Sc. in Physics</i>	Egham, UK 2014 – 2017

EXPERIENCE

The World Bank <i>Consultant</i>	Washington, D.C., USA May 2023 – June 2026
- Supported analytical work for the East Asia and Pacific Chief Economist's Office and previously the Poverty & Equity Global Practice, contributing to coauthored research, a flagship policy report, and a policy note on firm productivity for the Malaysian government. - Contributed to the <i>Firm Foundations of Growth</i> flagship report, analyzing how digitalization, skills, non-tariff measures, and pandemic resilience affect firm productivity, and to ongoing coauthored research on technology adoption in Vietnam using econometric and causal inference methods. - Used LLM-based APIs to classify unstructured product descriptions into HS/product categories for analysis. - Cleaned and analyzed multi-source datasets across 7 countries, combining firm financial statements, labor force surveys, input-output tables, and trade and tariff data; conducted firm-level production function estimation and misallocation analysis to generate policy-relevant findings for internal and client stakeholders. - Contributed to Afghanistan engagements, including coauthored research on machine learning-based poverty projections and economic activity analysis using nightlights data.	
University of California, Davis <i>Graduate Student Researcher (Prof. J. Edward Taylor)</i>	Davis, CA, USA Jun 2023 – Dec 2024
- Led quantitative analysis estimating the local economic impacts of refugee cash transfer programs in Mexico, Mauritania, and Moldova in collaboration with UNHCR and the American Institutes for Research. - Developed an R Shiny dashboard for local governments to track spending impacts across 4 protected areas in Sub-Saharan Africa, translating empirical analysis into clear visuals and metrics.	
United Nations Development Programme <i>Research Intern</i>	New York, NY, USA Jul 2022 – Sep 2022
Supported the 2021/22 <i>Human Development Report</i> by conducting analysis and producing visualizations for 2 sections of the report.	
Ford School of Public Policy, University of Michigan <i>Research Assistant (Prof. Yusuf Neggers)</i>	Ann Arbor, MI, USA Jan 2022 – May 2022
Conducted data analysis for a research paper, including scraping millions of rows of publicly available administrative data using Python, automating workflows with AWS, and managing storage in MySQL.	
Evidence for Policy Design, Harvard Kennedy School <i>Research Associate</i>	Delhi, India Jun 2019 – May 2021
- Executed 2 large-scale randomized controlled trials across 3 Indian states in collaboration with US-based economists, managing a field team of 15 members. - Collaborated with government officials to align project objectives and designed survey instruments for more than 1,000 officials. - Built Python data pipelines to scrape and process more than 50 million rows of public data from government websites and APIs. - Conducted econometric analyses, produced data visualizations, and prepared reports for internal and partner stakeholders.	
Koan Advisory <i>Economics Intern</i>	Delhi, India May 2018 – Jun 2018

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

- Barriga-Cabanillas, O., **Chawla, P.**, Redaelli, S. and Yoshida, N. 2025. “Estimating Poverty in Afghanistan Without Consumption Data: An Imputation-Based Approach.” *The Journal of Development Studies*, 1–22.
- **Chawla, P.** 2026. “Local Human Capital Development and Firm Resilience: Evidence from the 1997 Indonesian Crisis.” Working paper. Available at SSRN. (Job Market Paper)

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

“Are Technologies Appropriate for Developing Country Skills? Evidence from Vietnamese Manufacturing,” with Francesca de Nicola and Jonathan Timmis (World Bank East Asia Pacific)
“Firm Networks, Risk Sharing and Resilience to Shocks Among Small Firms in Tanzania,” with Daniel Putman and Jess Rudder
“Predicting Mexico-to-US Migration with Machine Learning for Counterfactual Analysis,” with J. Edward Taylor

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn), R, SQL/MySQL, Stata
Machine Learning and Causal Inference: Linear/Logistic Regression, Random Forests, Gradient Boosting, LightGBM, DiD, RDD, IV, PSM, Synthetic Controls, Panel Data Econometrics
Tools and Platforms: LLM APIs, agentic workflows, REST APIs, Git, Unix, Markdown, AWS (EC2, RDS), R Shiny, SurveyCTO

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2024–2026	Internal Grants (3 awards, \$6,000), UC Davis
2024	Giannini Dissertation Fellowship (\$21,500 stipend)
2024	Giannini Foundation Mini-Grant (\$20,000), with J. Edward Taylor
2024	Henry A. Jastro Graduate Research Award (\$3,000)
2021–2022	Provost’s Fellowship (\$25,000 stipend), UC Davis
2014	International Excellence Scholarship (50% tuition waiver), Royal Holloway

PRESENTATIONS

2026	9th Linked Employer-Employee Data Workshop (scheduled), AAEA Annual Meeting (scheduled)
2025	AAEA & WAEA Joint Annual Meeting (Best Poster Award Recipient), Japan Economic Policy Association, World Bank–LSMS Conference “Better Data for Better Jobs and Lives”, UC Davis Development Workshop, Giannini Student Research Conference

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Main Instructor: Economic Development (UC Davis; 2024)
Teaching Assistant: Operations Research & Management Science, Economic Development, Econometric Methods, Agricultural Labor, Intermediate Microeconomics, Math & Statistics for Economics
Teaching Fellow: Math Foundations Course (Ashoka University; 2018)

BLOG ARTICLES

“Government Intervention in India and Taiwan Affects Global Rice Markets” (with Tzu-Hui Chen), Ag Data News (2022)

LANGUAGES

English (Native/Bilingual), Hindi (Native/Bilingual), Korean (Beginner)